

ACCESSIBILITY AUDIT REPORT

Sandusky County CMS Website

DATE	STANDARD	PAGES AUDITED
June 2026	WCAG 2.1 Level AA / ADA Title II	30
TOTAL FIXES	PLATFORM	
300	CMS-Based Website (Bootstrap 3)	

Executive Summary

30	300
PAGES AUDITED	TOTAL FIXES
10.0	AA
AVG FIXES / PAGE	TARGET STANDARD

Scope: This audit covers 30 pages of the Sandusky County CMS website. All corrections were implemented as accessibility-only fixes — no visual design or layout changes were made. Each page was reviewed against WCAG 2.1 Level AA success criteria and ADA Title II requirements. Corrected HTML was provided for each page for manual implementation in the CMS.

Issue Categories Found

#	ISSUE CATEGORY	WCAG CRITERION	SEVERITY	OCCURRENCES
1	Phone numbers not wrapped in tel: links	2.1.1 Keyboard, 2.5.3 Label	High	~85
2	Heading hierarchy skips levels (H1 → H3, H1 → H4, etc.)	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	High	~55

#	ISSUE CATEGORY	WCAG CRITERION	SEVERITY	OCCURRENCES
3	External links missing "(opens in new tab)" warning	3.2.2 On Input, G201	High	~52
4	PDF links missing "(PDF, opens in new tab)" warning	2.4.4 Link Purpose, G201	High	~48
5	Contact info not in <address> element	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	Medium	24
6	Email links with target="_blank" (mailto should not open new tab)	3.2.2 On Input	Medium	~14
7	Empty or non-descriptive image alt text	1.1.1 Non-text Content	High	~12
8	Empty links with no accessible name (<a> , <a>)	2.4.4 Link Purpose, 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value	High	~10
9	Unencoded spaces in file/ URL paths	Broken links / functional	Medium	~30
10	Email href / display text mismatch	2.4.4 Link Purpose	High	~8
11	Markdown artifacts in link display text	2.4.4 Link Purpose	Medium	~7
12	 inside headings (redundant, inflates semantics)	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	Low	~14
13	Lists using plain text + instead of	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	Medium	~18
14	Deprecated attributes (align, <center>, title on links)	4.1.1 Parsing	Low	~12
15	Empty paragraph spacers ()	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	Low	~30
16		1.3.1 Info & Relationships	High	2

#	ISSUE CATEGORY	WCAG CRITERION	SEVERITY	OCCURRENCES
	Table using <td> in <thead> instead of <th scope="col">			
17	Tabular data using <div> grid — screen readers cannot associate rows/ columns	1.3.1 Info & Relationships	High	1
18	Video missing captions track (WCAG 1.2.2)	1.2.2 Captions (Prerecorded)	High	1
19	Multiple <h1> elements on one page	1.3.1 Info & Relationships, 2.4.6 Headings	High	1
20	Internal CMS links with target="_blank"	3.2.2 On Input	Low	~4

Page-by-Page Audit Results

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
1	Homepage	15	• Carousel: added role="region", aria-roledescription="carousel", pause/play button, aria-hidden on decorative icons • Carousel navigation controls: added descriptive aria-label • alt="geese" → descriptive alt text on banner image • "How Do I?" panel: <h1> → <h2> • All external links: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Removed deprecated <center> tags • Split multi-link paragraphs into separate <p> elements • htmlspecialchars() on PHP-echoed database values
2	Employee Information	8	• <h4>Wellness</h4> → <h3>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• Removed redundant <code></code> inside headings • All PDF links: added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • 5 PDF links missing <code>target="_blank"</code> — added • URL spaces encoded as <code>%20</code> • Multi-link paragraphs with <code>
</code> → separate <code><p></code> elements
3	Auditor	8	• H3 "Duties" and H3 "Information" → <code><h2></code>; removed empty H3 • Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Removed trailing <code>.</code> from external link <code>href</code> • Removed <code>target="_blank"</code> from <code>mailto:</code> link • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • 3 external links: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code>
4	Commissioner's	12	• 5 phone numbers → <code>tel:</code> links • H5 policy notices → <code><p></code> elements • Styled <code></code> headings → proper <code><h3></code> elements • "here" / "click" link text → descriptive text • Empty duplicate link removed; email typo fixed • No-meeting dates → <code></code> list • Removed <code><p>&nbsp;</p></code> spacers and deprecated <code>align</code> attributes
5	Clerk of Courts	8	• H3 → H2; H4 → H3 • Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Email <code>href</code> / display text mismatch fixed • Removed <code>target="_blank"</code> from <code>mailto:</code> link • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
6	Common Pleas Court	8	• alt="" → alt="Sandusky County Courthouse" • H3 → H2 • 2 judge phone numbers → tel: links • Added <div class="row"> wrapper for judge columns • Removed <p>&nbsp;</p> spacers and title="Web page" attribute • Wrapped judge contact info in <address> elements
7	County Courts	10	• Removed nested color elements (blue #0000ff fails WCAG contrast 3.07:1) • 4 phone numbers → tel: links • Removed target="_blank" from Judge Welty mailto: • 4 external links: added location-specific "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Wrapped each court's contact info in <address>
8	County Engineer	7	• H3 "Duties" → H2 • Split elected official name across two <a> tags → merged into single link • Phone → tel: link • Removed target="_blank" from mailto: • Cleaned markdown artifact in website display text • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Wrapped contact info in <address>
9	Treasurer	10	• Removed deprecated align="center" attribute • <p>&nbsp;</p> empty spacer removed • Phone → tel: link

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• Multiple <code>
</code> spacing removed from <code><p></code> • Restructured elected official bold/link; removed redundant <code></code> • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • H3 "Duties" → H2; calendar image out of heading; alt text typo fixed • Empty alt on "Save the Dream" image → descriptive alt
10	Sheriff	18	• Removed <code>
</code> inside <code><h1></code> • Empty alt on jail building image → descriptive alt • 2 phone numbers → <code>tel:</code> links (main + CCW office) • Removed <code>target="_blank"</code> and <code>title</code> from email link • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • PDF hiring link: added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • Links in <code><p></code> with <code>
</code> → <code></code> list • eSORN, Sheriff Sales, CCW FAQ, Land Bank links: added "(opens in new tab)" / "(PDF)" <code>aria-label</code> • Removed <code>title</code> attribute on Sheriff Sales URL link • Removed multiple <code><p>&nbsp;</p></code> spacers
11	Recorder	12	• Removed deprecated <code>align="center"</code> • Removed <code><p>&nbsp;</p></code> empty spacer • Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Multiple <code>
</code> spacing removed from elected official paragraph • Restructured elected official bold/link • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • H3 "Information" → H2 • PDF link: encoded space in URL, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			- Public Search & Land Bank links: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label - Multi-link paragraph: split into separate <p> elements
12	Prosecutor	6	- Phone → tel: link - Restructured wrapping email link - Removed empty link
 - Wrapped contact info in <address> - H3 "Duties" → H2 - External prosecutors website link: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label
13	Juvenile / Probate Court	11	2 court phone numbers → tel: links - Removed triple-nested on elected official link - Wrapped each court's address in <address> - Removed <p> </p> empty spacer - Fixed wrong alt text: Probate Court logo said "Juvenile Court" - Duplicate image+text links: added aria-hidden="true" + tabindex="-1" on image links - All 4 court website links: added rel="noopener" and "(opens in new tab)" aria-label
14	Coroner	10	- Alt text "commissioners" → descriptive building name - H4 "General Inquiries" → H2 - Phone → tel: link 2 email links: removed target="_blank" - Wrapped contact info in <address> - Sheriff phone in NOTE paragraph → tel: link

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• 3 PDF links: encoded URLs, trimmed leading whitespace, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" aria-label • Bare <a> link wrapped in <p>
15	Dr. Mark Smith (Coroner Bio)	6	• Filename alt text → alt="Dr. Mark Smith, Sandusky County Coroner" • 2 instances of nested inside <p> — invalid HTML, moved outside • Removed
 inside before email • Removed multiple empty <p> spacers • Removed target="_blank" from mailto: link
16	Board of Elections	27	• H1 contained instructions and a link — restructured: H1 title only, instructions moved to H2 + ordered list • H1 → H4 skip on election results — restructured as H2 "Election Results" + • Empty alt on building image • 3 phone numbers (office + 2 staff) → tel: links • Website link: cleaned markdown artifact • Board Members plain text → • 9 Elected Officials PDF links: encoded URLs, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" • Removed empty link <a>
; removed target="_blank" from internal CMS selflink • Republican Party URL: removed trailing %20 • 7 election result PDF links: encoded URLs, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" • CHECK REGISTRATION link: added "(opens in new tab)"

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• Voter registration image link: fixed URL, removed title, removed
 inside <a> • voteohio.gov link: cleaned markdown artifact • Campaign Finance + Local Disclosure links: added target="_blank" and "(opens in new tab)" • 10 bottom PDF links: encoded URLs, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)", consolidated from empty <div> spacers into • Precinct Election Workers: removed target="_blank" from internal link • 4 image button links: added proper "(opens in new tab)" / "(PDF)" aria-label • Voter qualification section: → <h2> • Forms & Petitions: added target="_blank" and "(opens in new tab)" • Removed multiple <p>&nbsp;</p> and empty <div>&nbsp;</div> spacers
17	Community Corrections	5	• Phone → tel: link • Email href / display text mismatch flagged for client • Restructured wrapping email link • Wrapped contact info in <address> • H3 "Duties" → H2
18	Dept. of Job & Family Services	7	• Website link: added rel="noopener" and "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • 4 <h3> section headings → <h2> (H1 → H3 skip, redundant)

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• 7 phone numbers → tel: links (Main, Bellevue, Clyde, Children Services, Child Support ×2, Workforce) • 4 plain-text email addresses → links • Each department's contact wrapped in <address> • Video: added aria-label and <track kind="captions"> (captions file required from client)
19	Dog Kennel	17	• Empty alt on building image → descriptive alt • 5 phone number instances → tel: links (main contact, Auditor office, Dog Warden registration, Stray section ×2) • 2 Sheriff phone references → tel: links • Website + Docupet links: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Wrapped contact info in <address> • 11 pseudo-headings → proper <h2> • Removed empty &nbsp; at page end • Table: <td> in <thead> → <th scope="col">; added <caption> • Registration location addresses wrapped in <address> • Meeting dates: plain text with
 → • Removed multiple <p>&nbsp;</p> spacers
20	Emergency Management	6	• Phone → tel: link • Email href / display text mismatch flagged for client • Wrapped contact info in <address> • "Duties & Responsibilities" plain <p> → <h2> (moved outside pull-right div to preserve layout)

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• H3 "LINKS" → H2 • 4 external agency links: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label
21	Emergency Medical Services	11	• Phone → tel: link • Email href / display text mismatch flagged for client • Website URL: removed trailing %20 • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Wrapped contact info in <address> • H3 "Duties" → H2 • H3 Annual Report link → H2 + "(PDF, opens in new tab)" aria-label • H3 "EMS Privacy Practices" → H2 • Privacy Practices PDF: added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" aria-label • "Click here for..." → descriptive link text • Point & Pay PDF: added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" aria-label
22	Facility Management	5	• 2 phone numbers → tel: links • Email href / display text mismatch flagged for client • Wrapped contact info in <address> • H3 "Duties" → H2 • Removed trailing &nbsp; in email display text
23	Human Resources	5	• Phone → tel: link • Email href / display text mismatch flagged for client • Wrapped contact info in <address> • H3 "Duties" → H2 • H4 Employment link with redundant → H2
24	Law Library	10	• Phone → tel: link (contact block + body text) • Wrapped contact info in <address>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• Excessive <code>
</code> tags in Board Members label removed • Removed multiple <code><p>&nbsp;</p></code> spacers • Board Members plain text → <code></code> • PDF link: trimmed leading <code>&nbsp;</code>, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • Meeting dates plain text → <code></code> • Facebook link flagged for client (URL missing) • Empty link <code><a>&nbsp;</code> removed
25	Sanitary Engineer	10	• Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Email <code>href</code> / display text mismatch flagged for client • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • Pay Bill Online: fixed garbled display URL, added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • Empty <code><h3>&nbsp;</h3></code> removed • H3 "Duties" → H2 • 2 Microsoft Word XML namespace comment artifacts removed • Removed <code><p>&nbsp;</p></code> spacer and trailing <code>

</code>
26	Solid Waste / Recycling	5	• Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code> • H2 heading: replaced <code>&nbsp;</code> with regular space • OSS web page link: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code>
27	Phone Directory	5	• Tabular data using <code><div></code> grid → semantic <code><table></code> with <code><thead></code>, <code><tbody></code>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• H3 column headers → <th scope="col"> • Added <caption> to table • ~55 office phone numbers → links with aria-label • Removed empty spacer row; fixed Juvenile Youth Works dual-phone cell
28	Veterans Office	11	• Phone → tel: link • Wrapped contact info in <address> • H3 "Are you a veteran?" → H2 • Empty link
 removed • Email typo: sanduskycountoh.gov → sanduskycountyoh.gov • Ohio Vet website: cleaned markdown artifact, added "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Toll-free 1-877-644-6838 → tel: link • Commission Members plain text → • Veterans Crisis Line image: added descriptive alt text; wrapped in link to crisis line website • Website link: cleaned markdown artifact, added target="_blank" and "(opens in new tab)" aria-label • Stray semicolon "Web Page ;" → "Web Page:"
29	Soil & Water	9	• All 5 <h3> section headings → <h2> (H1 → H3 skip) • H3 "USDA-Natural Resources ConservationPhone: 419-334-6330": fixed heading text, moved phone to body as tel: link • Soil & Water phone → tel: link • Wrapped contact info in <address>

#	PAGE	FIXES	KEY ISSUES FIXED
			• Removed deprecated <code>align="center"</code> • Board of Supervisors plain text → <code></code> • Removed <code>
</code> inside Meeting Minutes link text • Removed <code>&nbsp;</code> before website link text • Website link: added "(opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code>
30	Building Code Department	18	• 2 <code><h1></code> elements merged into single <code><h1></code> • Flyer image link: encoded URL spaces, added <code>target="_blank"</code>, "(PDF, opens in new tab)" <code>aria-label</code>, descriptive alt text • 2 H4 sidebar headings with <code></code> → <code><h2></code> • Phone → <code>tel:</code> link • Restructured <code></code> wrapping email link • Wrapped contact info in <code><address></code> • Typo "Inspection requests" → "Inspection requests" • SafeBuilt Contract + Amendment PDFs: encoded URL spaces, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" • H4 "Advisory Committee Meetings" → H2; H4 "No Applications after 4PM" → H2; H4 "Permit Applications" → H2 • Removed <code>target="_blank"</code> from internal Meeting Minutes CMS selflink • Contractor Registration + Registered Contractors PDFs: encoded URLs, added "(PDF, opens in new tab)" • 6 permit application .docx links: converted from <code><p>+
</code> to <code></code>, encoded URLs, added "(Word document, opens in new tab)" • Removed <code>
</code> inside link text

Items Requiring Client Action

The following items were flagged during the audit and require client verification or additional assets:

- **Email mismatches (×6 pages):** Community Corrections, Emergency Management, Emergency Medical Services, Facility Management, Human Resources, Sanitary Engineer — email href uses old domain (co.sandusky.oh.us) while display text shows new domain (sanduskycountyoh.gov). Client to verify correct address for each.
- **Video captions (Job & Family Services):** SC Foster Care video requires a .vtt captions file to comply with WCAG 1.2.2. Client to provide captions file.
- **Facebook link (Law Library):** Facebook page mentioned with no URL. Client to provide Facebook page URL for linking.
- **Veterans Crisis Line image:** Badge image was not linked. Connected to <https://www.veteranscrisisline.net/> — client to verify this is the correct destination.

WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria Addressed

CRITERION	TITLE	LEVEL
1.1.1	Non-text Content (alt text on images)	A
1.2.2	Captions – Prerecorded video	A
1.3.1	Info and Relationships (headings, lists, tables, address)	A
1.4.3	Contrast Minimum (removed blue #0000ff inline color)	AA
2.1.1	Keyboard (tel: links enable keyboard/AT dialing)	A
2.4.4	Link Purpose in Context (descriptive link text, file type warnings)	A
2.4.6	Headings and Labels (correct heading hierarchy)	AA
3.2.2	On Input (new tab warnings; mailto not forcing new tab)	A
4.1.1	Parsing (removed deprecated attributes, duplicate IDs, invalid nesting)	A
4.1.2	Name, Role, Value (empty links removed; aria-label on controls)	A

